

Comments for Planning Application DM2025/01591

Application Summary

Application Number: DM2025/01591

Address: Ambulance Station Dorset Road Belmont SM2 6JH

Proposal: Change of use from Sui Generis (Ambulance Station) to mixed use Classes F1 (Places of Worship) and F2 (Community Hub) involving the erection of a part one, part two storey front and side extension, increase in height to part of building and provision of cycle and refuse stores.

Case Officer: Polly Davidson

Customer Details

Name: Mrs Debra Upot

Address: 46 Burdon Lane Cheam SM2 7BY

Comment Details

Commenter Type:

Stance: Customer objects to the Planning Application

Comment Reasons:

Comment: I wish to submit a formal objection to planning application DM2025/01591 for the proposed use of the former ambulance station on Dorset Road as a place of worship.

While community and faith facilities play an important role within the borough, the proposed development raises serious concerns regarding highway safety, residential amenity and the suitability of this location for a potentially high-attendance destination use.

1. Highway Safety and Cumulative Impact on an already Sensitive Street

Dorset Road already accommodates sensitive community uses, including a primary school and a residential care home. These uses generate predictable peak periods involving children, elderly residents, carers, delivery vehicles and school-related traffic.

The introduction of a place of worship is likely to create additional concentrated traffic movements at similar peak times, particularly:

- weekday evening gatherings
- special religious events attracting large numbers of visitors

This cumulative activity risks significantly increasing congestion, unsafe parking and vehicle manoeuvres on a road already serving vulnerable users.

The presence of school children and elderly residents heightens the need for a precautionary

approach to highway safety. Increased visitor traffic, informal drop-offs and overspill parking could materially compromise pedestrian safety and safe access for emergency and care services.

2. Impact on Vulnerable Road Users

Planning decisions must consider the needs of vulnerable groups. The proximity of both a primary school and a care home means Dorset Road functions as a sensitive environment requiring calm traffic conditions, clear sightlines and reliable access.

A destination venue attracting large numbers of visitors may lead to:

- inappropriate parking near crossings and junctions
- obstructions of pavements
- increased noise and activity during sensitive periods

Such impacts would be inconsistent with maintaining a safe and appropriate environment for children, elderly residents and care home operations.

3. Residential Amenity and Noise Disturbance

The proposed use represents a significant intensification compared with the former ambulance station. A place of worship involves simultaneous arrivals and departures, social gatherings before and after services and potential evening and weekend activity.

Given the residential nature of Dorset Road, these patterns of use risk causing ongoing disturbance through noise, congregation outside the building and traffic-related impacts extending beyond normal residential expectations.

4. Suitability of the Site

Although the previous use was institutional, it did not operate as a public assembly venue attracting regular large gatherings. The constrained nature of the site and surrounding residential context raise doubts as to whether it is an appropriate location for a high-attendance community destination.

Alternative locations better served by main roads or commercial areas may be more suitable for such a use.

5. Insufficient Operational Information

The application does not appear to provide sufficient clarity regarding:

- expected congregation size
- service frequency
- hours of operation
- management of large events

Without this information, it is not possible to conclude that unacceptable impacts would be avoided.

Conclusion

For the reasons outlined above, particularly the highway safety implications arising from the proximity of a primary school and care home, I respectfully request that the Council refuse planning permission.